Foundation Inscription

From the sabil of Amir Inal al-Yusufi

Burji Mamluk, 794-95 AH / 1392-93 CE

W: 98.7 cm; H: 32.5 cm

Inv. no. 11747



"[Founded] this blessed water dispensary, through the grace of God Most High, his Excellency, the late Sayf al-Din Inal al-Atabaki al-Maliki al-Dhahiri, may God bestow His mercy upon him, dated Rabi' II year 795."

This foundation inscription, executed in naskh script, commemorates the establishment of a sabil by al-Sayfi Inal al-Atabeki al-Maliki al-Dhahiri, his epithets identifying him as Atabek al-'Asakir (Commander-in-Chief) and a former mamluk (slave soldier) of Sultan al-Zahir Barquq. Dated 795 AH (1393 CE), the inscription's use of al-marhum ("the deceased") reflects al-Maqrizi's record of Inal's death in 794 AH, indicating the sabil was completed posthumously. Epigraphically, the otherwise conventional naskh script is subtly enlivened by modest floral ornament: a small flower emerging from the ya' of al-Sayfi and a bifurcated leaf in the register below, characteristic flourishes of late fourteenth-century Mamluk calligraphic practice.

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